INC-2026-03-21: Delivers event webhooks to merchant endpoints with retry and degradation

Northwind Payments · SEV2 · service webhook-dispatcher · author d.nakamura

Started 2026-03-21T02:00:00Z · detected 2026-03-21T02:07:00Z · resolved 2026-03-21T02:56:00Z

Customer impact

Webhook delivery to all merchants was delayed by up to 55 minutes. No events were lost.

Root cause

Retry backoff was changed from exponential to linear, so a single unreachable merchant endpoint consumed the whole dispatch worker pool.

Causing change

This incident was caused by release wh-2.6.0, deployed to webhook-dispatcher. The release is recorded in the change log.

Affected services

webhook-dispatcher. Downstream services were affected through their dependency on webhook-dispatcher.

Timeline (UTC)

02:00 — Release wh-2.6.0 completed rollout earlier in the day.

02:00 — First symptoms observed on webhook-dispatcher.

02:07 — Alert pages the on-call engineer for webhook-dispatcher.

02:15 — Cause identified and mitigation begins.

02:56 — Service returns to baseline; incident resolved.

Action items

• Add an integration test covering the failure mode.

• Document the mitigation steps in the service runbook.

• Add saturation alerting to webhook-dispatcher at 80% of limits.